
Gas vent
SKS
The rifle used most by the Viet Cong was the SKS or Simonov, a semi-automatic, gas-operated carbine developed by the Soviets in 1945. Though soon superseded by the AK47 in the Soviet Army, it was widely used by communist insurgents in the 1960s and 1970s.
Hand guard around gas cylinder
Magazine filled from the top of the rifle
Magazine release catch
Gas cylinder located underneath the barrel
Ammunition belt
The RPD machine-gun was fed from a belt with 100 rounds contained in a circular drum that slotted into the bottom of the gun.
7.62mm rounds, the same as used in the SKS rifle and the AK47
Drum attached here
Drum containing 100-round belt
RPD AMMUNITION DRUM
RPD machine-gun
This successful Soviet weapon, developed towards the end of World War II, was exported to communist countries around the world. The Chinese produced their own version, the Type 56. Gas-operated and air-cooled, it had a bipod permanently attached, but was light enough to be fired from the shoulder like a rifle.
RUSSIAN F1 FRAGMENTATION GRENADE
VIET CONG COPY OF F1 GRENADE
RPG-2 GRENADE LAUNCHER
Grenade launchers
Developed by the Soviets as a hand-held anti-tank weapon, the RPG-2 rocket-propelled grenade launcher is fired by a single soldier, who rests the weapon over his or her shoulder. An improved version, the RPG-7, started to reach the Viet Cong about 1967. The grenades proved very effective against armoured vehicles, defensive positions and even helicopters in flight.
Rudimentary sight – weapon was very inaccurate except at short range
Firing hammer
Grenade, with its stabilizing fins folded, loaded here in the muzzle
RPG-7 GRENADE LAUNCHER
Metal cylinder encased in wood, which reduces heat from rocket's exhaust